

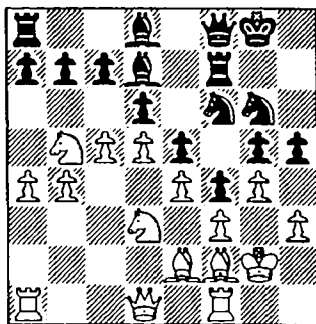


Diagram 8

Both sides' defences are rock solid

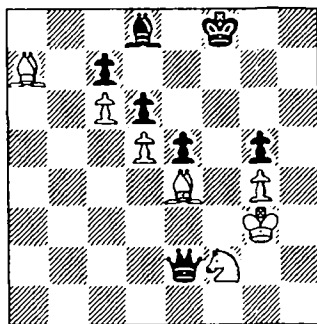


Diagram 9

Black cannot make progress

22 Nc3 Be7 23 Nh5 Bd8 24 Nc3 a6

Black decides to play for a win and is immediately rewarded by an error from White.

25 b5? axb5 26 Rb1

Here is an example of the x-ray pressure on the f-file at work. After 26 axb5 (26 Nxb5 Bxb5 27 axb5 will be similar) 26...Rxa1 27 Qxa1 the white queen has been dragged away from the defence of f3 so Black can play 27...hxg4 28 hxg4 Nxg4! 29 fxg4 f3+. So 26 Rb1 was not a deep pawn sacrifice but the only chance to complicate the game.

26...bxa4 27 Rxb7 a3!

Black is just going to use this pawn to distract the attention of White's pieces from the kingside.

28 c6 a2!? 29 Ra7 Nh4+! 30 Kg1 Rxa7 31 Bxa7 hxg4 32 hxg4 Bxg4! 33 fxg4 f3 34 Rxf3

34 Bxf3 would lose to 34...Nxe4!. All these combinations work because of Black's pawn on the 7th rank.

34...Nxf3+ 35 Bxf3 Nxe4?

Black takes the wrong pawn. 35...Nxd5! would have won easily.

36 Bxe4 Rf1+ 37 Qxf1 Qxf1+ 38 Kxf1 a1Q+ 39 Kg2 Qxc3

39...Qxa7 comes to the same. Black's combination has resulted in an endgame with an overwhelming material advantage – queen and pawn against two pieces – but unfortunately for him his king and bishop are eternal prisoners of the pawn chain. It is impossible to make any progress. Black played a few more moves to enable the sad news to sink in.

40 Be3 Qc2+ 41 Nf2 Qe2 42 Ba7 Kf8 43 Kg3 Qa6 44 Be3 Qe2 45 Ba7 (Diagram 9) Draw agreed

Game 15

□ Pinter ■ Nunn

Thessaloniki Olympiad 1988

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Be2 0-0 6 Nf3 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Ne1 Nd7 10 f3 f5 11 g4

So, another system where White tries to block the kingside. This version of g2-g4 was very popular in the 1980's but the eventual conclusion was that there was too much tension in the position for g2-g4 to be successful. Then White players started to wait for Black to play ...f5-f4 before playing g2-g4 and that is what we have just seen.

11...Kh8

Black's idea is to improve the position of the knight on e7 by playing ...Ng8. This introduces the possibility of playing ...Bh6 or ...Ngf6. Note that 11...f4? would be a serious mistake as after 12 h4! Black won't be able to create any play at all on the kingside. If he ever plays ...g6-g5 then White replies h4-h5 and if he plays ...h7-h5 White replies g4-g5.

TIP: In this variation Black should only consider playing ...f5-f4 when White has a bishop on e3.

12 Ng2

White's idea is to play h2-h4 so that if Black tries to exchange his 'bad' bishop by playing ...Ng8 and ...Bh6 he just gets kicked back by g4-g5. White can also play 12 Be3 or 12 Nd3.

12...a5

Black secures c5 for his knight, a particularly good square now that the white knight can no longer go to d3. With f6 earmarked for the other knight Black hopes to create strong pressure against e4.

13 h4 Nc5 14 Be3 Ng8 15 Rb1 Bd7 16 b3 b6 17 a3?! a4! 18 b4 Nb3

White's next move is played to prevent ...Nd4.

19 Nb5 Nf6 20 exf5 gxf5 21 Nc3 e4! 22 g5 Nh5 23 fxe4 f4!? (Diagram 10) 24 Bd2 Nxd2 25 Qxd2 Qe8 26 Bf3 Ng3 27 Rfe1 Be5

Black has sacrificed a pawn for total control of the dark squares. This ...e5-e4, fxe4 ...f5-f4 motif is an important theme in the King's Indian and other examples can also be found in the book.

28 Ne2 Nxe4!? 29 Bxe4 f3 30 Nef4 fxg2 31 Nxg2 Qh5 32 Qd3 Bg4 33 Re3 Qf7 34 Qd2 Qg7 35 Rd3 Rf7 36 Re1 Raf8 37 Ne3 Rf4 38 Ng2 R4f7 39 Ne3 Bh5 40 Rf1? (Diagram 11)

White should have played 40 Ng2 again with some chances to hold.

40...Rxf1+ 41 Nxf1 Rf4 42 Qe1 Bd4+ 43 Kg2 Qe5 44 Ng3 Bg4!

Black could win the queen with 44...Bf2 but he doesn't want to allow White to get a rook and a piece for it.

45 b5 Bf2 46 Qxf2 Bh3+! White resigns

White resigned because of 47 Kg1 Qa1+!.



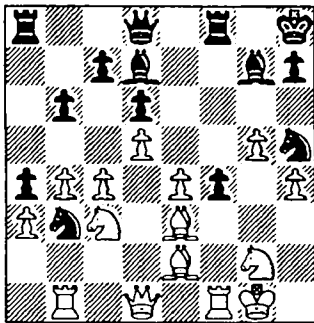


Diagram 10
An important motif

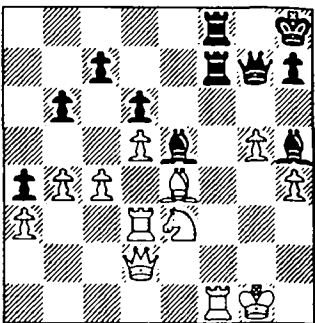


Diagram 11
Now White loses by force

White Plays 10 Be3

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Ne1 Nd7 10 Be3

The moves 10...f5 11 f3 f4 12 Bf2 g5 (Diagram 12) are now almost universally played so we will take this as our starting position.

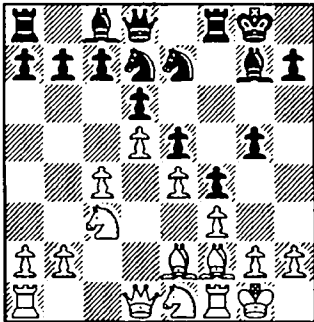


Diagram 12
The plans are clear!

This variation represents the King's Indian in its purest form. White will attempt to tear Black limb from limb on the queenside while Black will endeavour to hang, draw and quarter White on the kingside. Sometimes both players succeed and then Black wins. That is the advantage of attacking the king.

Pros and cons of 10 Be3

When I first started playing the King's Indian I just assumed that 10 Be3 lost by force. I couldn't believe that anyone would be so generous as to let ...f5-f4 be played with gain of tempo. Of course, I now realise that things are not so simple. The bishop on f2 is now perfectly placed to assist in the queenside attack while in other lines it becomes the white king's most valuable protector. However, it is also a target for a black pawn landing on g3.

Black's strategy

Black's main strategy in this line is based around playing ...g5-g4-g3. He doesn't care if it costs him a pawn as in return he will get open lines and outposts for his pieces. Perhaps the most important black piece in this line is the light-squared bishop. This is because if White meets ...g4-g3 with h2-h3 then Black will be able to sacrifice his bishop to rip open the white king position. You will see numerous examples of such sacrifices in the material below. The manoeuvre ...Rf6-h6, in order to gain a quick attack on the h-file, is also important.

From the diagram position White has tried many moves but we shall concentrate on the two main lines 13 a4 and 13 Rc1.

Theoretical?

It can be as theoretical as you want it to be. I could, for example, have easily filled up the whole book on just this variation. On the other hand, you could get by relatively well on general principles as the basic plans are quite straightforward.

Statistics

As a whole White has scored 56% from 1600 games with this variation. If we delve a little deeper White has scored 63% with 13 a4, the current main line. With 13 Rc1 White has scored 54% but if Black replies 13...Rf6 (Games 18 and 19) then White is down to 38% from 42 games! Korchnoi, who has been responsible for much of the theory in this variation, has scored 75% from 40 games with 10 Be3.

Illustrative Games

Game 16

□ Korchnoi ■ Xie Jun

Wentzou 1995

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Be2 0-0 6 Nf3 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Ne1 Nd7 10 Be3 f5 11 f3 f4 12 Bf2 g5 13 a4 Ng6

Black has an interesting, and in my opinion stronger alternative in 13...a5. That is covered in Game 17. 13...Rf6 is not thought to be so

Starting Out: The King's Indian

good here because of 14 Nb5 b6 15 a5. Certain players have tried 13...a6 followed by ...Rf6

14 a5

Korchnoi likes to get his pawn to a5 in this variation. He is probably already thinking about the new queen that is coming his way!

14...Rf7 15 b4

White has a major alternative here in the pawn sacrifice 15 c5!? Nxc5 16 Bxc5 dxc5 17 Bc4 Kh8 18 a6. Black has been under some pressure in this variation as well.

15...Bf8 16 c5 Nf6



NOTE: As a general rule Black keeps his knight on d7 as long as possible in order to make White work harder to play c4-c5. For example if Black had played 13...Nf6? – a common mistake – White can play 14 c5 without needing to prepare it with b2-b4 and without having to sacrifice a pawn.

17 c6! (Diagram 13)

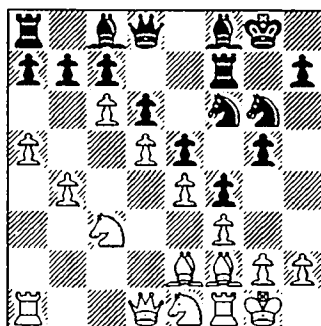


Diagram 13

One way into the queenside

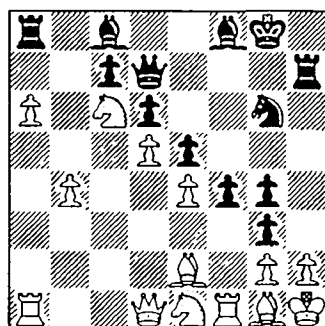


Diagram 14

What should White play?

Most players exchange on d6 in this type of position and try and invade on c7, but Korchnoi likes this c5-c6 move. He placed his pawn on a5 first so that Black couldn't block up the queenside with ...b7-b6

17...h5

Black doesn't take on c6 as after 17...bxc6 18 dxc6 White will have use of the d5-square

18 Kh1

Before he concentrates on his queenside attack, White makes one prophylactic defensive move on the kingside. It is important to have g1 free for his bishop so that it can retreat there when Black eventually plays ...g4-g3

18...Rh7 19 cxb7 Bxb7 20 a6! Bc8 21 Nb5

It didn't take long for the queenside attack to bear fruit. The a-pawn is doomed and with White's pawn already on a6 Black must deliver mate or lose the game.

21...g4 22 Nxa7 g3 23 Nc6 Qd7 24 Bg1

It is much too dangerous to accept the pawn. After 24 hxg3 fxg3 25 Bxg3 h4 followed by ...Nh5 Black has a massive kingside attack. That sort of variation is the cornerstone of Black's strategy.

24...Ng4?

I suspect Black is in a bad way already but she should have tried either 24...h4 or 24...gxh2.

25 fxg4 hxg4 (Diagram 14) 26 Bxg4!

By returning the piece White exchanges queens and forces an ending where the a-pawn is bound to have the final word.

Exercise 2: White would have happened to White if he had played 26 a7?

26...Qxg4 27 Qxg4 Bxg4 28 Nf3 Bxf3 29 Rxf3 Nh4 30 a7

There was still time for White to lose tragically: 30 Rfa3 f3 31 gxf3?? g2 mate. Korchnoi just keeps his rook on f3 to avoid any tricks. The a-pawn is going to collect far more than any exchange he may lose on the kingside.

30...Bg7 31 Ra5 gxh2 32 Bf2 Nxf3 33 gxf3 Kf7 34 Rb5 Bf6 35 Rb7 Kg6 36 b5 Kh6 37 Rb8 Rh8 38 Rxh8+ Bxh8 39 Bh4! Rg8 40 Kxh2
Black resigns

White is going to play Bd8.

Game 17

□ Koutsin ■ Frolov

Kiev 1995

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Ne1 Nd7 10 Be3 f5 11 f3 f4 12 Bf2 g5 13 a4 a5!?

This is an attempt to punish White for his move order. By blocking the queenside with ...a7-a5 and ...b7-b6 Black makes it very difficult for White to achieve his most dangerous queenside advance c4-c5.

14 Nd3 b6

The consistent follow-up. There is no point playing ...a7-a5 if Black just allows White to play c4-c5 afterwards.

15 b4

White must play b2-b4 at some point but there is a school of thought which believes that White should first shore up his kingside defences with 15 Be1 h5 16 Nf2 Nf6 17 h3 and only then play b4. As usual Black will aim for ...g5-g4.

15...axb4 16 Nb5

The immediate 16 Nxb4 is also possible with an unclear position after